

SOUTH AFRICAN SME OPERATING PACK

The SA Business Owner AI Prompt Pack

40 practical ChatGPT and Claude prompts for running a South African small business

Quotes, invoices, payments, hiring, compliance, and growth — without the admin headache.

Price: R199

Sales & quoting • Money & payments • Hiring • Compliance • Growth

This pack is for South African business owners who are drowning in admin.

It gives you 40 practical prompts you can paste into ChatGPT or Claude to move faster on quotes, invoices, payment chasing, hiring, compliance, and growth — written in South African English and aware of local context like POPIA, BBBEE, and how small-business owners actually operate.

This is not legal or financial advice. It is an operator pack built to help you draft faster, stay professional, and stop letting admin eat your day.

How to use it well

- Start with the prompt closest to the task.
- Paste in your real business context.
- Replace bracketed placeholders like [business name].
- If the first draft is weak, ask for it shorter, firmer, or more commercial.

What's inside

1. Sales & Quoting

2. Money & Payments

3. Suppliers & Negotiation

4. Customer Care

5. Hiring & People

6. Compliance & Admin

7. Operations & Growth

Use these like an operator, not a dreamer. The point is speed and professionalism in the boring, money-critical parts of your business — so you can focus on what only you can do.

Sales & Quoting

1. Quote Request Reply

Write a warm, professional reply to this customer enquiry and turn it into a quotation-ready response.

Business: [business name]

Offer: [product or service]

Customer message: [paste enquiry]

Turnaround time: [time]

Price range: [range]

Requirements:

- Use South African English
- Keep it concise
- Confirm scope clearly
- End with a direct next step

2. Formal Quote Draft

Draft a customer-facing quotation message for the following:

Business: [business name]

Client: [client name]

Scope: [scope]

Price: [price]

Valid until: [date]

Lead time: [lead time]

Exclusions: [exclusions]

Requirements:

- Clear headings
- No legal waffle
- Payment terms included
- Tone: professional and confident

3. Proposal Summary

Turn these rough notes into a one-page proposal summary for a South African SME client.

Notes: [paste notes]

Client goal: [goal]

Timeline: [timeline]

Budget: [budget]

Requirements:

- Problem
- Solution
- Deliverables
- Timeline
- Price
- Strong closing paragraph

4. Scope Clarifier

Create a discovery-question list I can send before quoting.

Business type: [type]

Service offered: [service]

Requirements:

- 10 sharp questions
- Designed to prevent scope creep
- Easy for clients to answer

5. Upsell Offer Email

Write an upsell email to an existing customer.

Current service: [service]

Observed need: [need]

Upsell offer: [offer]

Price: [price]

Requirements:

- Consultative
- Show business value
- Strong CTA

6. Follow-Up After No Decision

Write a follow-up for a prospect who went quiet after receiving a quote.

Prospect: [name]

Offer: [offer]

Quote date: [date]

Requirements:

- One gentle version
- One direct version
- One breakup message

7. Retainer Offer

Turn this service into a monthly retainer offer.

Current one-off service: [service]

Recurring need: [need]

Monthly scope: [scope]

Monthly price target: [price]

Requirements:

- Deliverables
- Boundaries
- Outcome-based positioning

Money & Payments

8. Invoice Cover Email

Write an invoice email for a South African client.

Business: [business name]

Invoice number: [number]

Amount: [amount]

Due date: [date]

Work delivered: [summary]

Requirements:

- Short and polite
- Mention POPIA-safe handling of contact details
- Include a firm payment reminder line

9. Overdue Payment Follow-Up

Write a payment follow-up email that is firm but still relationship-preserving.

Client: [client name]

Invoice number: [number]

Amount due: [amount]

Original due date: [date]

Days overdue: [days]

Requirements:

- South African English
- No aggression
- Ask for payment date confirmation
- Offer to resend invoice

10. Final Payment Reminder

Write a final payment reminder before escalation.

Client: [client name]

Invoice number: [number]

Amount due: [amount]

Previous reminders sent: [dates]

Requirements:

- Calm and serious
- Say services or deliverables may pause
- Ask for immediate confirmation

11. Debt Collection Call Script

Write a phone call script for following up unpaid invoices.

Client type: [type]

Amount due: [amount]

Days overdue: [days]

Requirements:

- Calm
- Direct
- Ask for a payment date
- Suitable for a South African small business owner

12. Late-Paying Customer Policy

Draft a short internal policy for handling overdue customer payments.

Business type: [type]

Current pain: [pain]

Requirements:

- Reminder schedule
- Escalation steps
- Tone rules
- When to pause work

13. Price Increase Notice

Write a customer notice for a price increase.

Current price: [price]

New price: [price]

Effective date: [date]

Reason: [reason]

Requirements:

- Honest
- Calm
- Preserve goodwill
- Encourage early renewal if useful

14. Debt Settlement Proposal

Draft a debt settlement proposal to a supplier or creditor.

Amount owed: [amount]

Proposed plan: [plan]

Reason for strain: [reason]

Requirements:

- Honest
- Credible
- Include payment dates

Suppliers & Negotiation

15. Supplier Price Negotiation

Write a negotiation email to a supplier asking for better pricing.

Business: [business name]

Supplier: [supplier name]

Current spend: [amount]

Requested concession: [discount, volume rate, terms]

Reason: [reason]

Requirements:

- Professional, not desperate
- Emphasise long-term relationship
- Ask for a concrete revised offer

16. Better Payment Terms Request

Write an email asking a supplier for improved payment terms.

Current terms: [terms]

Requested terms: [terms]

Reason: [reason]

Requirements:

- Respectful
- Commercially sensible
- Mention growth and repeat business

17. Late Delivery Complaint

Draft a supplier complaint about a late delivery.

Order details: [details]

Promised date: [date]

Impact on business: [impact]

Requirements:

- Stay factual
- Ask for corrective action
- Ask for revised delivery commitment

Customer Care

18. WhatsApp Follow-Up for Leads

Write three WhatsApp follow-up variants for a warm lead who asked about [service].

Business: [business name]

Lead name: [name]

Original enquiry date: [date]

Offer: [offer]

Requirements:

- Friendly, not needy
- One short version
- One more direct close
- One check-in style version

19. Customer Complaint Response

Write a response to a frustrated customer.

Complaint: [paste]

What happened: [summary]

Resolution available: [resolution]

Requirements:

- Empathetic opening
- Clear ownership
- Specific next step
- No robotic apology language

20. Refund Refusal with Alternative

Write a refund refusal message that protects the relationship.

Situation: [details]

Why refund is not available: [reason]

Alternative offered: [credit, redo, exchange]

Requirements:

- Clear but human
- Avoid sounding defensive

21. Testimonial Request

Write a message asking a happy customer for a testimonial.

Customer: [name]

Work done: [summary]

Result: [result]

Requirements:

- Easy to answer
- Offer 3 prompt questions they can reply to

22. Google Review Request

Write a short follow-up asking a customer to leave a Google review.

Business: [business name]

Customer result: [result]

Requirements:

- Friendly
- Not pushy
- Include a simple thank-you line

Hiring & People

23. Job Ad Draft

Draft a practical job ad for a small South African business.

Role: [role]

Location: [location]

Employment type: [full-time/part-time/contract]

Must-have skills: [skills]

Salary range: [range if sharing]

Requirements:

- Plain English
- Responsibilities
- Requirements
- Application instructions

24. Interview Question Pack

Create a focused interview question pack for this role:

Role: [role]

Level: [junior/mid/senior]

Key risks in role: [risks]

Requirements:

- 12 questions
- Include skill, judgment, and culture questions
- Add what a strong answer sounds like

25. Rejection Email

Write a respectful rejection email for an unsuccessful candidate.

Role: [role]

Candidate stage: [applied/interviewed/final]

Requirements:

- Kind
- Brief
- Keeps the door open if appropriate

26. Contractor Brief

Turn these rough notes into a clean brief for a freelancer or contractor.

Notes: [paste]

Budget: [budget]

Deadline: [deadline]

Requirements:

- Deliverables
- Acceptance criteria
- Deadline
- Communication expectations

27. Internal Memo

Turn these notes into a simple internal memo for staff.

Notes: [paste]

Change being announced: [change]

Effective date: [date]

Requirements:

- Clear
- No jargon
- Explain what changes in practice

28. Staff Warning Draft

Draft a fair, factual first written warning for an employee issue.

Issue: [issue]

Date of incident: [date]

Previous discussion: [details]

Expected improvement: [expectation]

Requirements:

- Factual
- Measured
- South African workplace context
- No inflammatory wording

Compliance & Admin

29. POPIA Data Request Reply

Draft a reply to a customer asking what personal information we hold and why.

Business: [business name]

Data held: [summary]

Purpose: [purpose]

Requirements:

- Simple language
- POPIA-aware
- No legal overkill

30. Privacy Notice Draft

Write a plain-language privacy notice section for a small South African business website.

Business type: [type]

Data collected: [data]

Use of data: [use]

Contact email: [email]

Requirements:

- POPIA-aware
- Easy to read
- No fake legal certainty

31. BBBEE Evidence Request

Write an email asking a supplier for their latest BBBEE certificate or affidavit.

Supplier: [supplier]

Reason: procurement records update

Requirements:

- Professional
- Brief
- Mention preferred format and deadline

32. Tender Clarification Reply

Write a professional reply to a tender or procurement clarification request.

Request: [paste]

Context: [context]

Answer points: [points]

Requirements:

- Formal
- Clear
- Easy to copy into a procurement email

Operations & Growth

33. SOP Draft

Create a simple standard operating procedure for this recurring task:

Task: [task]

Tools used: [tools]

Who owns it: [person]

Failure risks: [risks]

Requirements:

- Purpose
- Steps
- Quality check
- Escalation point

34. Monthly Client Update

Write a monthly client update email from these raw notes.

Notes: [paste]

Wins: [wins]

Issues: [issues]

Next month focus: [focus]

Requirements:

- Clear headings
- Professional tone
- Make the work feel valuable

35. Marketing Offer Sharpening

Improve this business offer so it is clearer, more specific, and easier to buy.

Current offer: [paste]

Target customer: [target]

Pain solved: [pain]

Requirements:

- Rewrite headline
- Rewrite promise
- Add 3 proof points
- Add a simple CTA

36. Partnership Pitch

Write a partnership outreach email for a small South African business.

Business: [business name]

Potential partner: [partner]

Why the fit makes sense: [reason]

Offer: [offer]

Requirements:

- Commercially sharp
- Specific
- Easy to reply to

37. Event Invite Message

Write an invitation message for customers or partners to attend this event.

Event: [event]

Date: [date]

Location: [location]

Why attend: [benefit]

Requirements:

- Email version
- WhatsApp version

38. Meeting Agenda Builder

Build a tight meeting agenda from these goals.

Meeting type: [type]

Goals: [goals]

Attendees: [attendees]

Time available: [minutes]

Requirements:

- Prioritised agenda
- Time per item
- Clear outcomes

39. Business Plan Summary

Write a one-page business plan summary for this small business.

Business idea: [idea]

Target customer: [target]

Revenue model: [model]

Startup needs: [needs]

Requirements:

- Market
- Offer
- Go-to-market
- Risks
- First 90 days

40. Board or Investor Update

Write a concise business update for a shareholder, advisor, or investor.

Period: [period]

Revenue: [revenue]

Costs: [costs]

Wins: [wins]

Risks: [risks]

Next priorities: [priorities]

Requirements:

- Sharp and factual
- Show control of the business

Final note: the value here is not just the prompts. It is the speed and professionalism they create in the boring, money-critical parts of your business — which frees you up to focus on what only you can do.

The SA Business Owner AI Prompt Pack

Prepared as a digital handbook for South African small business owners. Use the prompts, edit the inputs, save the outputs that work, and build your own templates from there.